2.5.3 Ordinary Time or the 12-Hour Format

The 12 hour clock has ante meridiem (a.m) and post meridiem (p.m) because the number of hours in a day is divided into day and night. In the clock, exactly 12.00 at night is called midnight; and exactly 12.00 at day is called noon.

a.m (ante meridiem) denotes the time that is after 12:00 midnight and before 12:00 noon.

p.m (post meridiem) denotes the time that is after 12:00 noon and before 12:00 midnight.

Example:



- Morning 5 o' clock is denoted as 5.00 a.m
- Evening 5 o' clock is denoted as 5.00 p.m
- In 3.20 a.m., the point does not mean the usual decimal point.

2.5.4 Railway Time or the 24-Hour Format



Generally, we use 12 hour clock but Railways, Airways, Defence forces and Television networks use 24 hour clock to avoid morning or evening confusions. When you are in a railway station, you can hear the announcement and see the use of hours instead of a.m. and p.m, because they follow the 24 hour format. Therefore, there is no need to say morning and evening in their time. Railway time is usually denoted in **4 digits.** The first two digits shows the hours and the last two digits shows the minutes. For example, 5 p.m is denoted as **17:00 hours.**

Example: 7 o' clock morning = 07:00 hours

1 o' clock evening = 13:00 hours (12+1 hour)

i.e., after 12 noon they count continuously up to 24 hours.

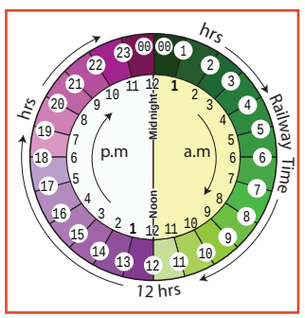
12 midnight is written as 00:00 hours or 24:00 hours.

12 noon is written as 12:00 hours



2.5.5 Conversion of Time Formats

Let us observe the clock. Remember the following points while converting from one type of time to another type



- To convert 12 hour time to 24 hour time, simply change 12 hours as 00:00 hours between 12.00 midnight and 01.00 a.m there is no change upto 01.00 p.m. Add 12:00 hours to any hour from 01.00 p.m.
- To convert 24 hour time to 12 hour time simply change 00:00 hours as 12 hours between 00:00 hours and 01:00 hour. There is no change upto 13:00 hours. Subtract 12:00 hours from any hours from 13:00 hours. Minutes will not change in both the formats

Convert into the 12 hour format: (Ordinary time)

24 hour format	>12 hour	if >12 hour then subtract 12	12 hour format
09:25 hours	No	-	9.25 a.m
18:40 hours	Yes	18-12= 6	6.40 p.m
03:15 hours	No	-	3.15 a.m
15:30 hours	Yes	(15-12=3)	3.30 p.m
23:50 hours	Yes	(23-12=11)	11.50 p.m

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